

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Suresh Rajasekaran

Address: 79 Northey Avenue Cheam SM2 7HU

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: My objection is based on the following material planning grounds:

1. Lack of Demonstrable Need

There are already several established community centres and halls operating within the SM2 postcode and surrounding Belmont area. These venues provide space for meetings, classes, worship, and community activities.

No clear evidence has been presented to demonstrate an unmet need for an additional facility of this scale. The proposal represents avoidable overprovision that would place further strain on local roads and residential amenity.

2. Traffic and Highway Safety

Dorset Road and the surrounding streets are quiet residential roads that are not designed to accommodate significant increases in traffic. A place of worship and community hub is likely to generate concentrated vehicle movements, particularly during evenings and weekends. Events, gatherings and organised activities may result in simultaneous arrivals and departures, creating congestion and increased risk to pedestrians.

There are schools in close proximity to the site. Additional traffic during school drop-off and pick-up times would raise serious highway safety concerns. Overspill parking on surrounding residential roads is highly likely if on-site provision proves insufficient, potentially obstructing driveways, narrowing carriageways and restricting emergency access.

3. Impact on Residential Amenity

The proposed use represents a substantial intensification compared to the former ambulance station. The regular congregation of large groups, combined with evening and weekend activities, would materially alter the quiet character of the area. Extended hours of use could lead to disturbance during evenings and weekends, undermining the peaceful residential environment currently enjoyed.

4. Scale, Bulk and Design

The proposal includes part one- and part two-storey extensions and an increase in height to part of the building. This raises concerns regarding over development of the site and visual impact on the street scene. The increased scale and massing may appear out of keeping with the surrounding residential character and could result in overshadowing or loss of outlook for neighboring properties.